CSE590-01 - Mid-Term Report: Progress Update (3–4 pages)

1) Title, Team, and Abstract (≈120–150 words)

- Project title and team members.
- One-paragraph abstract: problem, approach, what's done so far, one key preliminary result, and what's next.

2) Problem Statement & Goal Recap (≈0.5 page)

- Background & context (tight recap from proposal, updated if scope evolved).
- Objectives you committed to for the first half of the term (bullet these; they'll anchor your progress so far).

3) Methods & Implementation to Date (≈0.5–0.75 page)

- Pipeline/model diagram (small figure).
- Key design decisions: method/pipeline description, training *and/or* evaluation, ablations planned.
- Reproducibility notes: compute, libraries (e.g., PyTorch, HuggingFace, etc).

4) Preliminary Experiments & Results (≈1–1.25 pages)

- Setup summary (data you are using, models, metrics)
- Experiment table(s) with:
    - baselines vs your current method,
    - mean ± std over seeds if applicable, and
    - short caption describing what the table supports.
- Plots (if results are not in tables already).
- Interpretation (2–4 bullets): what worked, what didn't, any surprising failure modes.
- Validity checks: sanity checks, small preliminary results, or quick ablations. Clearly state results and significance (positive or negative) and why they matter relative to goals. Transparency about "goals not met yet" is expected in professional progress reporting.

5) Roadblocks, Risks, and Mitigations (≈0.5 page)

- Roadblocks encountered: data, compute limits, training instability, evaluation ambiguity, integration issues.

- Root-cause hypotheses and actions taken (e.g., smaller batch, gradient clipping, revised prompts, dataset filtering, model size vs GPU VRAM).
- Risk mitigation plan: each risk → probability/impact → contingency plan.
    - Status tags (Red/Yellow/Green) help make this scannable in one glance.

6) Updated Plan & Milestones (rest of page; tight bullets)

- Delta from original timeline: what shifted and why (scope trim or swap).
- Next-phase milestones with dates and objective criteria for task completion.
- Evaluation plan for final: additional metrics, stronger baselines, user study/logging, or external benchmarks you'll add.
- Success criteria (quantitative targets or qualitative acceptance tests) aligned with your proposal's evaluation plan.

7) References (short)

- Cite datasets, models, toolkits, and any baselines.